

RES100: Mental Health and Disability

Diya Advani, Alyssa Christou, Keeley McFadden, Zoe Oliver, and Arianna

Persaud-Harper

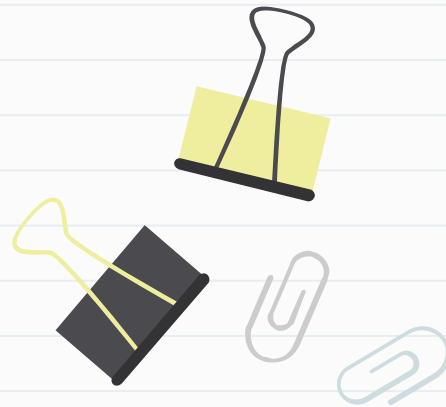


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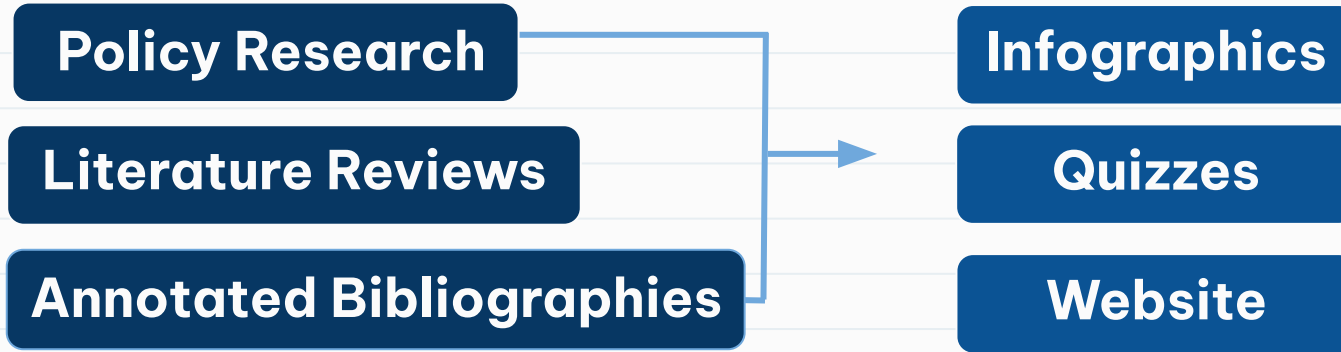
Skills and knowledge gained, challenges experienced, and our experience.

03

Closing Remarks

Final Remarks to our Placement

Project Overview + Our Goals



Our work here aims to:

- Produce **accurate educational tools**.
- Conduct research informing **public facing resources**.
- Collect **reputable resources**.
- **Expand** GLOCAL's resources.
- **Translate research** effectively.





01

Our Deliverables



Our Infographics

KNOW YOUR RIGHTS: MENTAL HEALTH AND DISABILITY IN BC

Mental health care should be respectful, accessible, and barrier-free, and people in BC should be able to get support without discrimination or confusion about where to go.

YOUR CORE RIGHTS!

RIGHT TO PRIVACY

- Your mental health information is confidential
- Schools/employers cannot share it without your consent

RIGHT TO ACCOMMODATIONS

- You have the right to academic or workplace accommodations
- Examples:
 - Extra time on exams
 - Flexible deadlines
 - Modified work duties

RIGHT TO ACCESSIBLE SERVICES

- You have the right to accessible mental health care and support services
- Services should be inclusive and respectful

RIGHT TO EQUAL TREATMENT

- You cannot be treated unfairly because of a mental health condition or disability
- Protected under human rights laws in BC

LAWS THAT PROTECT YOU!

BC Mental Health Act:

Sets rules for admission, treatment, and detention in designated mental health facilities, and includes rights and protections for patients

Accessible British Columbia Act:

Requires public organizations to make accessibility plans, create committees, and collect public feedback to remove barriers.

Canadian Charters of Rights and Freedoms:

Guarantees fundamental rights and freedoms, including equality rights that protect against discrimination by government institutions.

Accessible Canada Act

Aims to remove barriers and support dignity, choice, and equal access in federally regulated areas.



DID YOU KNOW?

- Mental health conditions are recognized as disabilities under human rights law
- You do NOT need to disclose everything to receive accommodations

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION!

If you need further information on mental health and disability supports, please go to BC Government site of Disability Services and/or BC Health for Mental Health Supports for further information.



Stigma and Mental Health in Ontario

As of 2021:

26% of Ontarians report fair or poor mental health

19% report a substance abuse disorder

ER visits for mental health increased by 47%

Stigma = Negative beliefs and stereotypes about mental illness

A major barrier to receiving mental healthcare

- 60% of mentally ill Canadians will not seek help due to fear of the stigma that comes with a label of mental illness

Stigma prevents help-seeking at multiple points in the healthcare system:

Before Entry:

- Feelings of shame
- Lack of awareness about mental illness
- Fear of diagnosis affecting a career

During Care:

- Turned away for not fitting exact diagnostic profile
- Labeled "not sick enough"
- Symptoms dismissed based on stereotypes about gender or race

After Care:

- Made to feel like a failure if treatment is unsuccessful
- Labeled either curable or incurable

These experiences discourage people from accessing mental healthcare.

How Can You Fight Stigma?

Educate Yourself

- Understanding mental illness is a crucial step to reduce stigma

Educate Others

- Encourage friends and family to do research
- Call out stereotypical, stigmatizing ideas about mental illness (eg. calling mentally ill people "crazy")

Advocate for Change

- Join mental health advocacy groups
- Stay informed on policies, legislation, mental health, education and care

Resources



Resources

- Anti-stigma training and educational resources
- Advocacy for mental health service access
- Mental health, education and services

canadian.ca/health

GLOCAL FOUNDATION OF CANADA MENTAL HEALTH AND DISABILITY NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR

01

ACCESSIBILITY POLICIES

Implemented in 2021, the Newfoundland and Labrador Accessibility Act outlines goals and policies to improve social support and well-being within the province, by identifying and removing obstacles.

Key Portions of the Act's Support:

- Reducing and removing mental health and disability barriers
- Building facilities and tools to support disabilities
- Creating accommodations within workplaces, education systems and communities

02

COMMUNITY SUPPORTS AND SERVICES

Mental Health Supports (CMHA)

The CMHA is a website with a variety of tools. The organization provides programs, education, training, live events and many other tools, to accommodate different communities in terms of mental health and recovery.

Bridge The Gap

Bridge The Gap is a web resource that focuses on offering tools and events, online and in person to tailor to the needs of everyone struggling with mental health. Resources offered include coping techniques, informative pages about various struggles such as substance use, as well as emergency services.

Disability Supports (CDD NL)

CDD NL provides resources for those who live with disability in NL. They have various tools, such as information to help reduce stigma, transportation services, environmental and physical accessibility aids, employment opportunities, financial aid, housing, service animals and more.

Empower NL

Empower NL provides job opportunities exclusively for disabled people. They have services to provide resources for organizations, provided aid includes advice, planning, and events. They also provide technology support to disability needs.

03

UNDERSTANDING BARRIERS

- Current action plan is considered short term, and won't last long term
- Highest self-harm rate in Canada, highest hospitalization rate due to them
- Rural to urban ratio 40% is considered rural, impacting availability of access to care, as well as availability
- Less access to care, leading to the misinterpretation of less diagnosis

Arianna Persaud-Harper - 2026

New Brunswick:



Addiction Services

SUBSTANCE USE RATES:

27.9% vs. 20.7%

NEW BRUNSWICK AVERAGE CANADA'S OVERALL AVERAGE

New Brunswick has the highest rates of substance use in Canada, as well as half the number of psychiatrists compared to the country's average.

Are you concerned for yourself or a loved one? Here's what you can do:



THE NEW BRUNSWICK ADDICTION AND MENTAL HEALTH HELPLINE

- toll free
- supports callers with substance use, gambling, and mental health concerns
- direct callers to other help sources
- support and guide family members and friends
- crisis intervention

ENSEMBLE OVERDOSE PREVENTION SITE

Ready to provide:

- Primary healthcare services
- supervised injection booths
- harm reduction education and support
- Take home naloxone kits



THERE IS HOPE

You don't have to go through addiction alone. New Brunswick can help concerned families and friends ensure safety for their loved ones

ENSEMBLE Overdose Prevention Site: 80 Weldon St Moncton, NB E1C 5V8

The New Brunswick Addiction and Mental Health Helpline: 1-866-355-6550



MENTAL HEALTH IN ALBERTA

What You Should Know

Alberta is facing some of the most serious mental health challenges in Canada. Here's a look at the numbers, the barriers, and what you can do.

29.3% 14.3 39.4

When mentally ill people use of food, housing, safety, and education are compared to the rest of Canada.

Who's Being Left Behind?

1 Youth mental health care use rose between 2014 and 2022, but the increase is not reaching everyone equally.

- Girls and young women are accessing services at higher rates than boys
- Youth from higher-income neighbourhoods are getting more help than those from lower-income areas
- Rural and northern communities have fewer psychiatrists per capita than the rest of the province
- Self-harm emergency visits among children and youth have been rising steadily since 2010

Barriers to Getting Help

- Cost and stigma: The AISH program supports people with severe disabilities, but proposed changes (AISH) could reduce benefits and limit the right to appeal decisions
- Awareness: Many people don't know what services exist or which level of government is responsible for mental health care
- Stigma: People reporting poor mental health also report a lower sense of belonging in their communities
- Geography: If you don't live near Edmonton or Calgary, specialized mental health care is much harder to access
- 40% of Canadians living with a mental illness will not seek help due to fear of stigma (CMHA, 2024)

What's Being Done?

2 Recovery Alberta: A new provincial agency taking over mental health and addiction services, aiming to expand crisis care and mental health first aid

Can We Talk? Campaign Run by CMHA and the Alberta Teachers' Association, helping mental health educators directly into classrooms across the province

Public support to share: Over 10% of Albertans support anti-stigma training for healthcare workers and mental health programs in schools (YouthLink et al., 2020)

Learn Your Rights

Mental health conditions are recognized as disabilities under Canadian human rights law

Talk About It

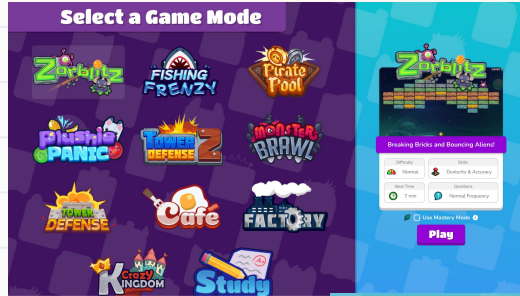
Normalize mental health conversations with friends, classmates, and family

Know Where to Go

Start with your family doctor or contact Alberta Health Services' mental health line

References: CMHA (2024). The state of mental health in Canada: 2024 report. CMHA (2024). The state of mental health in Canada: 2024 report. CMHA (2024). The state of mental health in Canada: 2024 report. CMHA (2024). The state of mental health in Canada: 2024 report.

Quiz Games: Blooket and Quizziz

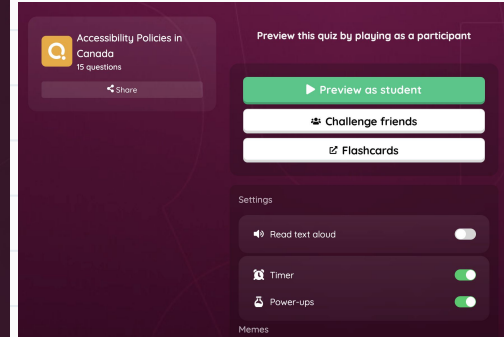


Quizizz is now
WAYGROUND

Bridge classroom realities and curriculum expectations with the platform that's AI-supported, but teacher-first.

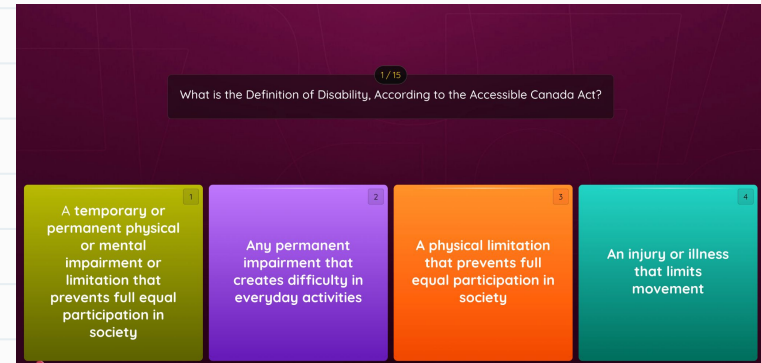
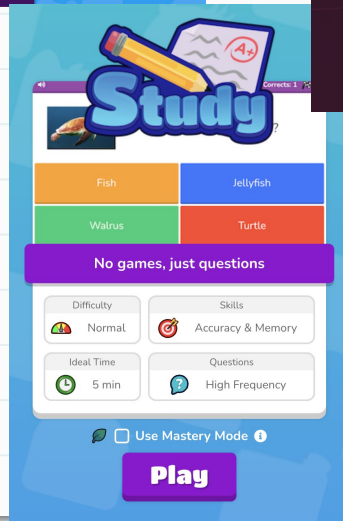
TEACHERS
Sign up for free

ADMINISTRATORS
Get in touch

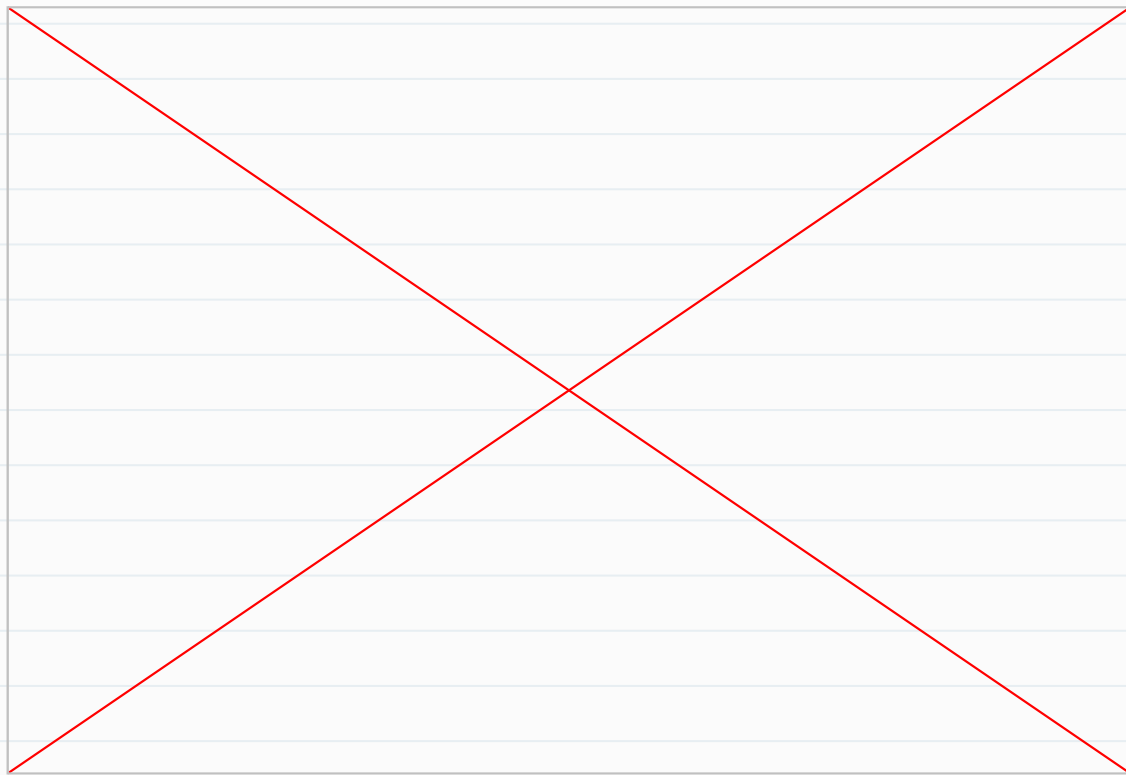


Disability in Canada!

Learn about disabilities in a fun and easy way! This quiz will help you understand how everyone is different and how you can be kind and inclusive. We suggest having a discussion before or after the quiz game to help the kids better understand the importance of accessibility and inclusion.



Our Website!





02

Our Skills & Challenges



Alyssa Christou

Skills I gained:

- Organizational skills
- Researching skills

Knowledge I learned:

- Various barriers and personal recounts of experiences with mental health and disability services

Challenges I Faced:

- Engery management/burnout

What I Would Do Differently:

- Asking for clarification sooner!

Overall Experience:

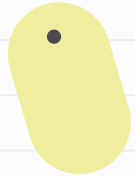
- Valuable, rich, and informative



Keeley McFadden



Skills I gained: Policy research, annotated bibliography writing, research translation, collaboration



Knowledge I learned: Disability and mental health policies in Canada

Challenges I Faced: Multitasking, burnout

What I Would Do Differently: More time!

Overall Experience: Good! I liked the flexibility, learning about policies, and turning statistical knowledge into educational resources!

Zoe Oliver

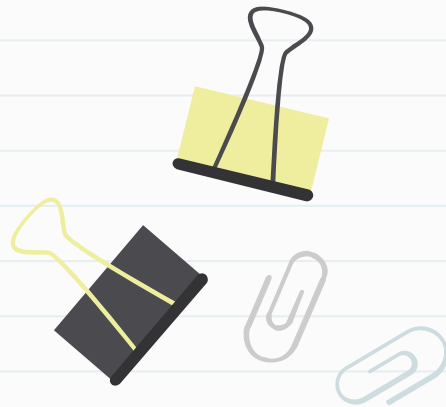
Skills I gained: Research analytics (policies), Writing Skills (APA/doing an annotated bibliography for the first time), enhanced communication and collaboration skills

Knowledge I learned: systematic barriers preventing individuals from receiving care, importance of civic literacy and accessible educational tools

Challenges I Faced: Overwhelming amount of work leading to burnout

What I Would Do Differently: Attend more in person showcase events

Overall Experience: Amazing! Led me to the conclusion that I do want to work in research focusing on bettering my community and making resources more available and accessible!



Arianna Persaud-Harper



Skills I gained:

- Adaptation to situations, literature/writing, research, population consideration (tool/resource creation)

Knowledge I learned:

- Civic literacy and its importance in populations

Challenges I Faced:

- Task interpretation/inquiries

What I Would Do Differently:

- Structure and timing, in person vs online

Overall Experience:

- Very good! Having the opportunity to preach the organization when asked about my placement was also very fun!

Diya Advani



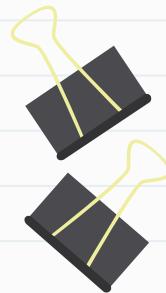
Skills I Gained: Knowledge mobilization, conducting literature reviews across academic and legal sources, reading provincial legislation, remote collaboration, managing large volumes of research

Knowledge I Learned: How mental health and disability are handled in Canadian law, how social determinants shape mental health outcomes, how stigma operates at public and institutional levels, how the AISH program works and concerns around ADAP

Challenges I Faced: Volume of material was consistently heavy, remote isolation was harder than expected, didn't expect so much legal reading, separating work from personal time got harder after midterms

What I Would Do Differently: Ask for feedback more often instead of waiting

Overall Experience: Changed how I think about where psychology can be applied. Came in expecting a standard research role and left with a new understanding of how policy, law, and public education intersect with mental health.



To Conclude

- This project helped us understand how mental health and disability are handled across Canada and turn that research into something the public can actually use.
- We support GLOCAL's mission of making civic information accessible for all Canadians.
- Thank you to our supervisor for the guidance and for giving us the space to learn and grow.